Know Your Rights in Research

If a researcher invites you or your community to take part in a study, these are your rights and the questions you can ask.

Three things to remember

You can say no
Taking part is your choice

You can stop anytime
With no penalty

Your data is protected
And kept private

Your key rights

Your Rights

- **You can say no.** Taking part is always your choice.
- **You can stop at any time,** with no penalty.
- **You can skip any question** you do not want to answer.
- **You have the right to understand the study** in plain language, and in your language when possible.
- **Your information should be protected** and kept private.
- **You can ask how the results will be used** and who will see them.

Questions to Ask Before You Say Yes

- Has this study been approved by an ethics review board (IRB)?
- What is the study about, and why did you choose us?
- What will we be asked to do, and how long will it take?
- Is information available in our language?
- How will our information be protected?
- How will you share the results with our community?

Warning Signs

- No one can tell you whether the study has IRB approval.
- You feel pressured to agree quickly.
- The purpose is unclear, or keeps changing.
- There is no plan to share results with your community.

Remember: You can always pause, ask more questions, or say no.

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